Hourly rates of new short-form editors (no badge)

Pulled live from Upwork on **29 October 2026**. These are 37 short-form video editors with **no Top Rated or Top Rated Plus badge** who appeared in the searches "short form video editor" (worldwide and Nigeria only) and "short form video editor" with the Rising Talent filter. No result was a paid (boosted) placement. "Earned" is Upwork's own rounded figure, and JSS is their Job Success Score. A dash means no score yet.

Short answer

- **Most new editors charge $10/hr.** The middle rate is **$10/hr** and the average is **$12.70/hr**, with a range of $5–$30.
- **Nigerians charge a bit less:** middle **$10/hr**, average **$9.20/hr**, range $5–$15.
- **Higher earners charge more.** Editors under $1K earned have a middle rate of $10. Those with $1K–$9K earned have $12. The three with $10K+ earned charge $12–$20 (middle $19).
- **Your $18/hr is in the upper group.** That's fine, because it matches what editors with $10K+ earned charge. The data shows new editors win their first jobs with small **fixed prices** ($10–$30 per clip), not with their hourly rate.

How the 37 rates spread

Hourly rate	Editors
$3–$6	8
$8–$12	14
$15	6
$19–$20	7
$25–$30	2

Earned so far	Editors	Middle rate	Range
Under $1K	11	$10/hr	$5–$20
$1K–$9K	22	$12/hr	$5–$25
$10K+	3	$19/hr	$12–$20

Nigerian editors without a badge (9)

Freelancer	Country	Rate	Earned	JSS	Exact title
Isaac T.	Nigeria	$5/hr	$1K+	94	YouTube Sports Video Editor | NBA, NFL, Shorts & Reels
Chioma U.	Nigeria	$5/hr	$300+	—	Short Form Video Editor | YouTube Short, Instagram Reels, TikTok Video
Michael A.	Nigeria	$6/hr	$800+	100	AI Video Ads Creator For DTC Brand | Veo3 Kling Seedance Higgsfield
Elizabeth P.	Nigeria	$10/hr	$1K+	77	Short Form Video Editor | Reels, Youtube Shorts, TikTok Video Editing
Gbolahan A.	Nigeria	$10/hr	$500+	100	AI Video Creator & Editor | UGC & Direct Response Ad | DTC, Higgsfield
Nawwal I.	Nigeria	$10/hr	$3K+	100	Instagram Reels Editor for Wellness Brands | UGC & Short-Form Video
Margret Ifeoma I.	Nigeria	$10/hr	$7K+	100	AI Video Creator |HeyGen Expert |AI Talking Head Videos |Voice Cloning
Favour I.	Nigeria	$12/hr	$8K+	83	Short-Form Video Editor | Talking Head Reels, TikTok & Podcast Clips
Badmus M.	Nigeria	$15/hr	$7K+	93	AI Video Creator | AI Video UGC | Ai Avatar Video | Ai Video Editing

Other countries without a badge (28)

Freelancer	Country	Rate	Earned	JSS	Exact title
Tatheer A.	Pakistan	$5/hr	$2K+	89	Short Form Video Editor | YouTube Shorts, Reels & TikTok Editor
Laiba B.	Pakistan	$5/hr	$800+	100	Professional Video Editor | Video Editing | YouTube Video Editor
Mustafa I.	Pakistan	$5/hr	$2K+	100	YouTube Video Editor | Reels, Shorts, Ads & Motion Graphics
Syed R.	Pakistan	$6/hr	$1K+	100	Video Editor | YouTube Videos, Meta Ads, TikTok Ads, Insta Reels
Lam P.	Vietnam	$6/hr	$900+	100	Professional Video Editor | Instagram | Youtube | Tiktok | Reels
Amna S.	Pakistan	$8/hr	$1K+	100	Pro Video Editor | AI Video Generation | AI Video ads for Ecommerce
Eman F.	Pakistan	$8/hr	$100+	100	Video Editor | Motion Graphics, Short & Long-Form Video Specialist
Linh D.	Vietnam	$10/hr	$600+	100	Senior Video Editor | High-Retention Short-Form & YouTube Content

Freelancer	Country	Rate	Earned	JSS	Exact title
Areej R.	Pakistan	$10/hr	$1K+	100	Video Editor for Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts | Viral Content Expert
Mohamed A.	Tunisia	$10/hr	$300+	100	Short Form Video Editor (TikTok, Instagram Reels, Youtube Shorts)
Zee E.	Egypt	$10/hr	$400+	—	Video Editor | Reels & Short-Form | Motion Graphics & AI Video
Samar F.	Pakistan	$10/hr	$6K+	100	High-Retention Video Editor | Reels, TikTok, Shorts & UGC Ads
Sana A.	UAE	$12/hr	$1K+	90	Video Editing Expert | Short-Form Videos | AI Video, Reels & TikTok
Sarita R.	India	$12/hr	$20K+	82	Short-Form Video Editor | UGC Ads, Reels & TikTok
Dung N.	Vietnam	$15/hr	$1K+	100	Professional Video Editor | Youtube Video | Shorts Video Expert
Gustavo V.	Brazil	$15/hr	$1K+	—	Video Editor
Alexandro Damian P.	Argentina	$15/hr	$700+	100	Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & UGC Ads | Premiere & CapCut
Muhammad A.	Pakistan	$15/hr	$4K+	100	YouTube Video Editor | Long-Form, Reels & Shorts | DaVinci Resolve
Iqra K.	Pakistan	$15/hr	$2K+	100	UGC Video Editor | Video Ads Specialist | TikTok, Meta & Instagram Ree
Vu D.	Vietnam	$19/hr	$10K+	88	Video Editor | Real Estate Expert | short video | ads video
Bui N.	Vietnam	$20/hr	$10K+	100	Short Form Video Editor for Personal Brands, Coaches & Founders
Dua D.	Pakistan	$20/hr	$2K+	100	Short-Form Video Editor for TikTok, Instagram Reels & YouTube Shorts
Sameh M.	Egypt	$20/hr	$1K+	100	Short-Form Ad Editor (English & Arabic) | UGC & AI Video Ads
Bao N.	Vietnam	$20/hr	$2K+	100	AI Video Editor & AI Video Creator | YouTube, UGC, Tiktok & Meta Ads
Leo M.	Philippines	$20/hr	$5K+	—	AI Filmmaker & Video Editor with 15 yrs Experience in Film & TV VFX
Abdul Aziz U.	Pakistan	$20/hr	$200+	100	Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok, Shorts | Premiere & CapCut
Joshua F.	Philippines	$25/hr	$7K+	—	Video Editor
Nicolas B.	Spain	$30/hr	not shown	100	Video Editor & Motion Designer | Short-Form Ads, Reels & Clips

What this means for you

1. **Keep $18/hr on your profile.** Bui N. (Vietnam, $20/hr, $10K+), Vu D. ($19/hr, $10K+) and Dua D. ($20/hr, 20 contracts in about 2 months) show that a no-badge editor can charge $18–$20 and still win work.
2. **Win your first jobs with fixed prices.** Quote $10–$30 per clip or use your catalog packages. Most first jobs in the study were $10–$50 fixed-price.
3. **Don't drop to $5/hr.** The $5 editors mostly earned under $3K. Isaac T. now lists $5/hr, but his 40 jobs are all fixed-price $10–$80, so his hourly rate isn't what wins him work.
4. **Raise prices after 5–10 reviews.** The no-badge editors who earned $10K+ all charge $12–$20/hr.